

Lesson 05:

Seemingly Unrelated Ayat: Al-Qiyamah and Al-'Ankabut

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Passages in the Quran sometimes seem to jump from one topic to another. In Surah Al-Qiyamah, Allah goes from addressing man's skepticism of Judgment Day, to telling His Prophet (PBUH) not to hasten his recitation. In Surah Al-'Ankabut, Allah describes the trials of previous prophets as Muslims were being tortured. While these topics may seem unrelated, they display a subtle, yet profound, wisdom.

Two Dimensions of تَدَبَّر

﴿٢٤﴾ أَفَلَا يَتَدَبَّرُونَ الْقُرْآنَ أَمْ عَلَى قُلُوبٍ أَقْفَالُهَا ﴿٢٤﴾ “Don’t they seek behind the wording of the Quran?”- (47:24)

- Allah is saying that not reflecting on the Quran is an indication of locks on the heart (spiritual problem).
- تَدَبَّر is directly related to the health of one’s heart because conviction will be reinforced by way of contemplation. Along with this, تَدَبَّر gets rid of contradictions (intellectual problem). Faith is both in our hearts and in our minds and تَدَبَّر fortifies faith both spiritually and intellectually.
- Reflection is about the heart. Contemplating on the Quran will keep our emotions in check; creating an emotional bound on sadness, jealousy, greed, etc.
- Quran does both spiritual and emotional healing.
- تَدَبَّر can’t properly be accomplished if one looks at the Quran merely to quote a preconceived notion at someone.

Seemingly Unrelated Ayat: Surah Al-Qiyamah

The surah begins discussing people who are skeptical about Judgment Day and how they will be shocked on that Day. Then the topic shifts and Allah tells the Prophet (PBUH) not to move his tongue quickly to hasten the recitation of the Quran. Everything had to do with the afterlife except the part about not hastening the recitation. The Prophet (PBUH) was rushing to recite in order to change their hearts with perhaps the next ayah or the next. He was desperate to get them to change course because he knew the end is near. Allah, in this ayah, tells the Prophet

(PBUH) that reciting more won't make it clear to them. Allah is contrasting the Prophet's sense of urgency to recite and his concern for them if they continue in their defiance.

Seemingly Unrelated Ayat: Surah Al-'Ankabut

Background on the surah:

- People are being tortured because they're Muslim. In response to that, this surah was revealed.
- In the surah, Prophet Nuh (PBUH) is mentioned, then Prophet Ibrahim (PBUH) and then Prophet Lut (PBUH). Prophet Nuh escaped punishment by water, Prophet Ibrahim escaped punishment by fire, and Prophet Lut voiced his intention to migrate. All of them did hijrah and left their respective homelands.
- Here Allah was subtly telling the sahaba that the time to migrate has come, and that He will get them out. In fact, this surah was revealed right before the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) and his companions' hijrah to Medina.